HALF MY PRODUCT DEMOED AS AN EMPTY PAGE

I opened the shipping side to show somebody, and it opened on nothing.

The demo tenant is a parallel empty database. That is the whole reason this happened.

A BLANK SCREEN IS NOT A NEUTRAL SCREEN

The feature worked. It had shipped, it had tests, it ran fifty shipments in 254 seconds the week before.

But the demo tenant is deliberately empty, so what the other person saw was a page with a heading and white space underneath it.

> **A blank screen does not read as no data. It reads as unfinished.**
>
> THE VIEWER CANNOT TELL THE DIFFERENCE, AND THEY WILL NOT ASK.

This is a selling bug, not a rendering bug.

WHAT AN EMPTY STATE OWES THE VIEWER

01	Say what lives here in one line	NAME IT
02	Say why it is empty right now	EXPLAIN
03	Show the shape, one sample row, marked as a sample	SHAPE
04	Give the one action that fills it	NEXT
05	Never leave a bare heading over white space	NEVER

Sample rows carry a visible sample label so nobody mistakes them for a real order.

WHAT THE VIEWER CONCLUDES

BARE HEADING

Unfinished

They stop asking about the feature, and they quietly downgrade everything else you showed them.

EXPLAINED EMPTY

Ready

They ask how the data gets in, which is the question you actually wanted.

SO EVERY SURFACE CARRIES ITS STATE

MARKER	MEANS
In daily use	**eleven people touch it every working day**
Built and working, lightly used	**real, not yet load bearing**
Built, not handed over	**no client book on it yet**
Empty by design	**demo tenant, sample rows only**

Marked on the page itself rather than in a sales deck.

THIS IS NOT A SOFTWARE PROBLEM

Every business has a version of the empty page. The catalogue with no photos on half the items. The quote with a blank lead time. The price list where four rows say call us.

The reader does not read a gap as missing information. They read it as a company that has not finished the job.

SEE THE FILLED VERSION

I will walk it with sample data that is labelled as sample data, and tell you which surfaces are load bearing today.

DEMO TENANT | MATURITY SAID OUT LOUD | NO SCREENSHOTS OF A REAL BOOK

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